

Q At what stage can I have a 3D ultrasound of my baby?

3D ultrasounds can be done at any stage of your pregnancy. They show still pictures of your baby in three dimensions. 4D ultrasounds show moving 3D images of your baby, with time being the fourth dimension. With these, you will see your baby's skin rather than her insides.

In the US, standard prenatal care usually offers only a 2D image of your baby. However, there are many private clinics that will offer 3D (and even 4D—with sound) ultrasounds, if you're happy to pay for them. Ask your doctor for recommendations of reputable private prenatal clinics near you. Some women worry that creating the 3D image must mean using rays that could be harmful to the baby, but a 3D (or 4D) ultrasound is no more dangerous than one that is 2D—the sound waves are just put together from more angles to create the 3D image. If you are carrying more than one baby this type of ultrasound is really useful since it can show whether fetuses share a placenta or amniotic sac and can provide valuable information about the state of a pregnancy.



3D ultrasound This allows parents-to-be to see what their unborn baby looks like.



14 weeks By 12 weeks a fetus is fully formed, and may be possible to tell the gender of a baby at 14 weeks. If you want to see your whole baby on a 3D ultrasound photo, then make sure you have one earlier on in your pregnancy. Space gets tighter as the weeks go by.



Close-up 3D ultrasounds reveal a vast range of expressions on the face of a fetus, for example, frowning and smiling. Sometimes a fetus can be seen opening its mouth. This 38-week-old fetus is rubbing her eyes.



Triplets In this amazing 3D image of triplets, each fetus has its own sac. In between the sacs a small amount of placenta is seen as a V-shape. This indicates that each fetus not only has its own sac, but also its own placenta.